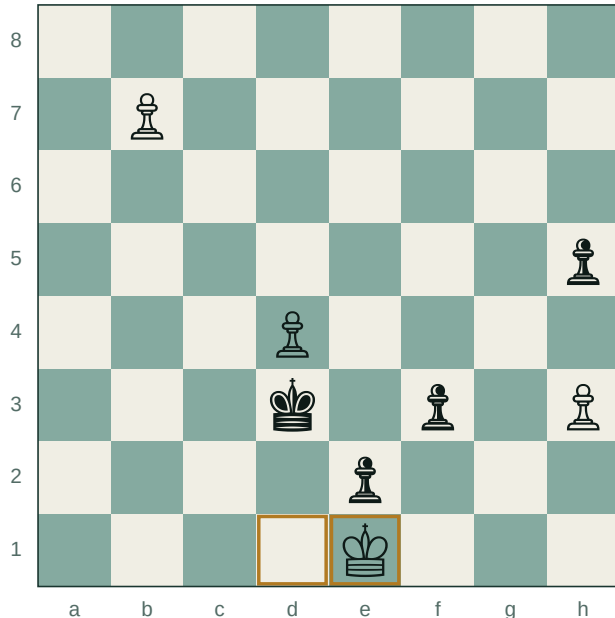


Pawn-ending calculation: Black, move 49

Pawn-ending calculation

Black to move



Previous move: 49.Ke1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49...Ke3 50. h4 f2#

49...Ke3 The king moves from d3 to e3. Recorded reply: **50.h4**.

50...f2# Mate: pawn on f2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Pawn on f2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not enter a pawn ending because it looks simple. Rook-pawn exceptions and zugzwang can make a material advantage irrelevant.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

With only kings and pawns, a single tempo can reverse the result. Calculate opposition, capture routes, promotion races, and reserve pawn moves precisely.

HOW TO LOOK

Count actual king moves and pawn pushes, then include whose turn it is and whether promotion gives check.

The defending king is on e1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.